

Philipp Hilbert. *Senior Product Owner for complex digital manufacturing environments.*

Positioning, product owner with ten years translating operational complexity into backlog-ready requirements, now applying that to manufacturing and quality digitisation.

BERLIN, GERMANY · [HILBERT@TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN](mailto:hilbert@true-north.berlin) · [TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN](https://www.true-north.berlin)

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · www.true-north.berlin · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)

The engagement description identifies a specific structural problem: a heterogeneous system landscape that has grown faster than the governance around it, with rising domain requirements and insufficient alignment between business goals and the product roadmap. That is not a technology problem. It is a product ownership problem, and it is one I have solved repeatedly.

At Emil Group, I inherited a 17-person team with collapsed sprint discipline, a backlog that no one trusted, and a client base on the verge of disengaging. Within weeks I restructured the team into smaller Scrum units, reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement, and ran weekly product workshops that rebuilt stakeholder confidence. Delivery stabilised. Senior developer attrition dropped from near-total to a single departure. The mechanism was the same one this engagement requires: clear ownership, disciplined prioritisation, and the ability to translate domain complexity into work that engineers can act on.

At Rohde & Schwarz, the domain was AI data infrastructure for a multinational defence programme. The regulatory and quality requirements were stringent, the stakeholder landscape was international and interdisciplinary, and the system had to satisfy both technical auditability and operational transparency. I delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end, from user stories through implementation support to GitOps rollout, and unblocked infrastructure-level issues that had been sitting unresolved for over a year. That is the combination of depth and pragmatism this role calls for.

At the Federal Employment Agency, I served simultaneously as product manager for a public analytics platform and as deputy IT security officer, managing compliance, data lineage, and governance alongside feature delivery. I introduced Dagster for automated ETL pipelines, migrated legacy systems to Kubernetes, and maintained delivery continuity across major system upgrades. Working at the intersection of operational systems, data quality, and regulatory constraints is familiar ground for me.

The nice-to-have items in this posting – regulated environments, quality and process knowledge, KPI-based steering, integration complexity – are not gaps I need to bridge. They are the conditions I have worked in across three consecutive roles. I do not have chemical industry background specifically, and I have named that honestly. What I bring instead is a demonstrated ability to enter a complex domain, build credibility with operational stakeholders quickly, and deliver product outcomes under exactly the kind of pressure this engagement describes.

I am available on four weeks' notice, fluent in German and English, and comfortable with the remote/on-site split indicated. I look forward to discussing the engagement in detail.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
